

TECH CAREER ROADMAP

Cloud (AWS-First) · DevOps · Cybersecurity · AI-Era Security · Offensive Security

A compressed 4-month sprint for a CS new grad targeting Toronto tech roles in Q1 2027.
AWS CCP + SAA + Security+ + portfolio project + AI security skills + job search — all by September 1.
This is an aggressive timeline. 30+ hours/week minimum. No days off from the plan.

Timeline	May 1 – September 1, 2026 (4 months / 17 weeks)
Cloud Platform	AWS (primary) + Azure (secondary exposure)
Study Load	30–35 hours/week minimum (non-negotiable at this pace)
Version	v3.0 — Compressed Sprint
Generated	April 30, 2026

WHAT CHANGED FROM v2 (8-month plan): CCP compressed to 10 days (it's easy for CS students). SAA compressed to 5 weeks. Security+ compressed to 4 weeks. Phase 5 tracks (AppSec, SOC, GRC, AI Security) run CONCURRENTLY with portfolio build to save 3 weeks. Offensive security moved entirely post-Sep 1 (Tier 3 — do it while employed). Job search prep is the final week, with full-intensity applications starting Sep 1. **This works only if you do 30+ hrs/week.**

TARGETING STRATEGY

Tier	Roles	Strategy
TIER 1	Jr DevOps / Platform / Cloud / Infra Engineer, GRC / IT Risk Analyst	Apply aggressively starting Sep 1. Banks + consulting = primary.
TIER 2	SOC Analyst (MSSP), Cloud Support, Jr Security Consultant	Apply in parallel. SOC = stepping stone (12-18 mo max).
TIER 3	Pentester / Red Team / AI Security Researcher	Build CTF skills AFTER Sep 1 while employed in Tier 1/2.

17-WEEK COMPRESSED TIMELINE

#	Period	Weeks	Focus	Deliverable
1	May 1–11	1.5	Cloud Foundations + AWS CCP	AWS CCP Cert
2	May 12–Jun 15	5	AWS SAA Deep Dive	AWS SAA Cert
3	Jun 16–Jul 12	4	Security+ (accelerated)	CompTIA Security+ Cert
4	Jul 14–Aug 3	3	Portfolio Project + AI Sec + AppSec + SOC + GRC (concurrent)	ParcelVision on AWS + security skills + write-ups
5	Aug 4–24	3	AI Security + remaining skills + Azure exposure	AI security write-ups + AZ-900 study + GRC frameworks
6	Aug 25–Sep 1	1	Job search launch prep	3 resumes + LinkedIn + portfolio + first 15 applications

PHASE 1 — AWS CLOUD PRACTITIONER (CLF-C02)

May 1 – May 11, 2026 | 10 Days

Goal: Pass CCP in 10 days. This is aggressive but realistic for a CS student — CCP is fundamentally a vocabulary exam. You already understand computing concepts; you just need to learn AWS-specific names and pricing models. 4–5 hours/day.

Days 1–4: Core Services + Infrastructure (May 1 – May 4)

- [] Cloud models (IaaS/PaaS/SaaS), deployment models (public/private/hybrid) **May 1**
- [] AWS global infra: Regions, AZs, Edge Locations, Local Zones **May 1**
- [] Compute: EC2 (instance families, pricing: On-Demand/Reserved/Spot), Lambda, ECS/EKS **May 2**
- [] Storage: S3 (classes, lifecycle), EBS, EFS — when to use each **May 3**
- [] Networking: VPC basics, subnets, IGW, NAT, Route 53, CloudFront **May 3**
- [] Databases: RDS, Aurora, DynamoDB, Redshift — relational vs NoSQL decisions **May 4**

Days 5–7: Security + IAM + Billing (May 5 – May 7)

- [] IAM: Users, Groups, Roles, Policies, least privilege, MFA **May 5**
- [] Shared Responsibility Model — what AWS secures vs what YOU secure **May 5**
- [] Security services: GuardDuty, Inspector, Macie, WAF, Shield, KMS, CloudTrail, Config **May 6**
- [] Billing: Free Tier, Cost Explorer, Budgets, Trusted Advisor, Organizations, Support plans **May 7**
- [] Set up AWS free tier account — launch EC2, create S3 bucket, create IAM user **May 7**

Days 8–10: Practice Exams + Pass (May 8 – May 11)

- [] Complete 3 full Tutorials Dojo CCP practice exams **May 9**
- [] Review every wrong answer. Flashcards for confused services. **May 10**
- [] **BOOK AND PASS AWS CCP EXAM (CLF-C02)** **May 11**

DEADLINE: May 11 — AWS CCP PASSED. Non-negotiable.

RESOURCES

- **Andrew Brown (ExamPro) CCP Course:** Free on YouTube (~14h). Best free CCP course. Watch at 1.5x speed.
- **Tutorials Dojo CCP Practice Exams:** \$12. Gold standard. Do every single one.
- **Tech With Lucy (YouTube):** Canadian cloud engineer. CCP breakdowns + career advice.

PHASE 2 — AWS SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT ASSOCIATE (SAA-C03)

May 12 – June 15, 2026 | 5 Weeks

Goal: Pass SAA in 5 weeks (compressed from 7). Possible because CCP gave you the vocabulary. Now you go deep on architecture. 5–6 hours/day. Adrian Cantrill's course is non-negotiable — do NOT substitute with a cheaper/shorter course.

Weeks 1–2: IAM + Compute + Networking (May 12 – May 25)

- [] Cantrill SAA: IAM deep dive (policy evaluation, cross-account, permission boundaries) **May 15**
- [] EC2 deep dive (placement groups, ENIs, EBS vs instance store, AMIs) **May 18**
- [] VPC deep dive (NACLs vs SGs, peering, endpoints, Transit Gateway, Flow Logs) **May 22**
- [] Lab: Multi-tier VPC by hand — public web + private DB + NAT + bastion **May 25**

DEADLINE: May 25 — IAM + EC2 + VPC complete. Lab deployed.

Week 3: Storage + Databases + Serverless (May 26 – Jun 1)

- [] S3 deep dive (encryption, replication, access points, presigned URLs) **May 28**

- [] RDS (Multi-AZ, read replicas), Aurora, DynamoDB (partition keys, GSI/LSI) **May 29**
- [] Lambda, API Gateway, Step Functions, SQS, SNS, ECS/Fargate, ECR **May 31**
- [] Lab: Serverless API (Lambda + API Gateway + DynamoDB) **Jun 1**

DEADLINE: June 1 — Storage, DB, serverless, containers complete.

Week 4: Advanced + Security + HA/DR (Jun 2 – Jun 8)

- [] CloudFront, Route 53, ELB/ALB/NLB, Auto Scaling, Global Accelerator **Jun 4**
- [] CloudWatch, CloudTrail, Config, GuardDuty, Security Hub, KMS, ACM **Jun 5**
- [] HA patterns: Multi-AZ, multi-Region, pilot light, warm standby **Jun 7**
- [] Migration: Snow Family, Storage Gateway, DMS. Cost optimization. **Jun 8**

DEADLINE: June 8 — All SAA course modules complete.

Week 5: Exam Prep + Pass (Jun 9 – Jun 15)

- [] ALL Tutorials Dojo SAA practice exams (4 minimum) **Jun 12**
- [] Review every wrong answer. Score 82%+ consistently. **Jun 14**
- [] **BOOK AND PASS AWS SAA EXAM (SAA-C03)** **Jun 15**

DEADLINE: June 15 — AWS SAA PASSED. Non-negotiable. You now have 2 AWS certs.

RESOURCES

- **Adrian Cantrill SAA Course:** learn.cantrill.io — ~\$45 USD. Non-negotiable. Best SAA course.
- **Tutorials Dojo SAA Practice Exams:** Gold standard. Buy the set.
- **Johnny Chivers (YouTube):** Deep AWS architecture. Networking + security focus.
- **Cloud Mechanic (YouTube):** Short, dense service-specific videos.
- **Be A Better Dev (YouTube):** AWS with code examples and real deployments.

PHASE 3 — COMPTIA SECURITY+ SY0-701 (ACCELERATED)

June 16 – July 12, 2026 | 4 Weeks

Goal: Pass Security+ in 4 weeks (compressed from 6). Aggressive but achievable — you have a CS foundation and just learned cloud security concepts in SAA. Professor Messer at 1.5x speed + heavy practice exams. 5 hours/day.

Week 1: Domains 1–2 (Jun 16 – Jun 22)

- [] Domain 1: General Security Concepts (CIA triad, AAA, zero trust, defense in depth) **Jun 18**
- [] Domain 2: Threats, Vulnerabilities, Mitigations (malware, social eng, attack vectors) **Jun 22**
- [] Set up home lab: VirtualBox + Kali Linux + Metasploitable3 **Jun 22**

Week 2: Domains 3–4 (Jun 23 – Jun 29)

- [] Domain 3: Security Architecture (segmentation, cloud models, encryption, PKI) **Jun 26**
- [] Domain 4: Security Operations (monitoring, IR lifecycle, SIEM, SOAR) **Jun 29**
- [] Lab: Install Splunk Free. Ingest logs. Write 5 SPL queries. **Jun 29**

Week 3: Domain 5 + Practice (Jun 30 – Jul 6)

- [] Domain 5: Security Program Management (GRC, compliance, risk, audits) **Jul 2**
- [] ALL Professor Messer practice exams (3 minimum) **Jul 5**
- [] Jason Dion practice exams as supplement **Jul 6**

Week 4: Final Prep + Pass (Jul 7 – Jul 12)

- [] Review PBQ formats: drag-drop, log analysis, config scenarios **Jul 8**
- [] Score 82%+ consistently on all practice tests **Jul 10**
- [] **BOOK AND PASS COMPTIA SECURITY+ SY0-701** **Jul 12**

DEADLINE: July 12 — SECURITY+ PASSED. Non-negotiable. 3 certs in hand.

RESOURCES

- **Professor Messer SY0-701:** Free on YouTube. Buy practice exams (\$30).
- **Jason Dion Practice Exams:** Udemy. Harder than real exam.
- **Cyberkraft (YouTube):** Better than Messer on cryptography.
- **John Hammond (YouTube):** Malware analysis + CTF walkthroughs. Watch 2-3/week.
- **MyDFIR (YouTube):** SOC analyst projects. Replicate his lab builds.
- **TryHackMe SOC Level 1 path:** Start during this phase, finish in Phase 4.

PHASE 4 — PARCELVISION BUILD + CONCURRENT SECURITY SKILLS

July 14 – August 3, 2026 | 3 Weeks

Goal: Deploy ParcelVision on AWS AND build AppSec/SOC/GRC skills SIMULTANEOUSLY. Morning = project build. Evening = PortSwigger/Splunk/GRC study. This is the highest-intensity phase. 6–7 hours/day, split across both tracks.

TRACK A: PARCELVISION DEPLOYMENT (mornings, 3–4 hrs/day)

Week 1: Terraform + Containers + CI/CD (Jul 14 – Jul 20)

- [] All AWS infra in Terraform (VPC, subnets, SGs, ECS, RDS, S3) **Jul 16**
- [] IAM roles per service (no access keys, use task roles) **Jul 16**
- [] Remote state: S3 backend + DynamoDB locking **Jul 17**
- [] Dockerize Flask app (multi-stage build) → push to ECR **Jul 18**

- [] GitHub Actions pipeline: lint → test → build → scan → deploy **Jul 19**
- [] Trivy (container scan) + Semgrep (SAST) + Checkov (IaC scan) integrated **Jul 20**

Week 2: Security Hardening (Jul 21 – Jul 27)

- [] Encryption: S3 SSE-KMS, RDS encryption, EBS encryption, ACM certs, TLS 1.2+ **Jul 23**
- [] CloudTrail + GuardDuty + AWS Config rules + VPC Flow Logs → CloudWatch **Jul 25**
- [] Security Hub enabled — achieve passing score **Jul 26**
- [] Secrets Manager for API keys (Gemini API, etc.) **Jul 27**

Week 3: Monitoring + Docs (Jul 28 – Aug 3)

- [] CloudWatch dashboards + alerting (unauthorized calls, SG changes, errors) **Jul 30**
- [] Architecture diagram (draw.io) + Security Decisions document **Aug 1**
- [] Comprehensive README + 3–5 min demo walkthrough video **Aug 3**

DEADLINE: August 3 — ParcelVision LIVE on AWS. Terraform, CI/CD, security scanning, monitoring, full docs.

TRACK B: APPSEC + SOC + GRC (evenings, 2–3 hrs/day, concurrent with Track A)

AppSec — PortSwigger Labs (Jul 14 – Aug 3)

- [] SQL Injection labs (Apprentice + Practitioner) **Jul 17**
- [] XSS labs complete **Jul 20**
- [] Authentication + Access Control labs **Jul 24**
- [] SSRF + Path Traversal + File Upload labs **Jul 27**
- [] Burp Suite Community Edition used for every lab **Jul 14**
- [] 3 professional vulnerability write-ups (finding → impact → fix → PoC) **Aug 3**

SOC Skills (Jul 14 – Aug 3)

- [] Complete TryHackMe SOC Level 1 path (started in Phase 3) **Jul 24**
- [] Splunk Fundamentals 1 complete **Jul 27**
- [] BOTS v1 dataset investigation done **Aug 1**
- [] MITRE ATT&CK:: tactics, techniques, detection mapping understood **Aug 3**

GRC Foundations (Jul 14 – Aug 3)

- [] SOC 2 Type II: 5 Trust Service Criteria **Jul 18**
- [] ISO 27001 structure + NIST CSF 5 functions **Jul 22**
- [] OSFI B-13 guidelines (Canadian bank requirement) **Jul 26**
- [] PIPEDA basics + Quebec Law 25 awareness **Jul 30**
- [] Write sample risk assessment + Acceptable Use Policy **Aug 3**

PHASE 5 — AI-ERA SECURITY + REMAINING SKILLS + AZURE EXPOSURE

August 4 – August 24, 2026 | 3 Weeks

Goal: This is your differentiation phase. AI security knowledge separates you from every other 2027 grad. Also: finish remaining AppSec write-ups, study OWASP Top 10, add Azure exposure, study AI governance frameworks. This is what makes you interview-ready.

AI-ERA SECURITY — NEW ATTACK SURFACE

Why this matters: Every company deploying AI creates vulnerabilities that traditional security doesn't cover. Almost no entry-level candidates know OWASP LLM Top 10 or MITRE ATLAS. This is your edge.

Week 1: Understanding AI/ML Threats (Aug 4 – Aug 10)

- [] OWASP Top 10 for LLM Applications (2025) — read cover to cover **Aug 5**
- [] Prompt Injection: direct, indirect, jailbreaking — practice on vulnerable LLM apps **Aug 6**
- [] Data Poisoning, Model Theft/Extraction, Supply Chain attacks on ML pipelines **Aug 7**
- [] Insecure Output Handling: XSS via LLM, SQL injection via LLM **Aug 8**
- [] Excessive Agency: when AI agents get manipulated into harmful actions **Aug 9**
- [] Study real incidents: Samsung ChatGPT leak, Air Canada chatbot case, Microsoft Tay **Aug 10**

Week 2: Defending AI Systems + AI-Powered Attacks (Aug 11 – Aug 17)

- [] MITRE ATLAS (Adversarial Threat Landscape for AI Systems) — ATT&CK; for AI **Aug 12**
- [] Guardrails: input validation for LLMs, output filtering, sandboxing agent actions **Aug 13**
- [] How attackers USE AI: AI-gen phishing, deepfakes, automated vuln discovery **Aug 14**
- [] Lab: Exploit vulnerable LLM app (OWASP WebGoat AI or Damn Vulnerable LLM App) **Aug 15**
- [] Lab: Implement guardrails on LLM API (input sanitization, rate limiting, logging) **Aug 16**
- [] AI-augmented SOC: how CrowdStrike Charlotte AI, Microsoft Copilot for Security work **Aug 17**

Week 3: Write-ups + Azure + AI Governance + OWASP Top 10 (Aug 18 – Aug 24)

- [] Write 2 AI security blog posts: LLM prompt injection (with PoC) + securing AI in AWS **Aug 20**
- [] Complete remaining 2 AppSec write-ups (total = 5 AppSec + 2 AI = 7 write-ups) **Aug 21**
- [] Study OWASP Top 10 (2021) — explain each, give examples, describe fixes **Aug 21**
- [] Study OAuth 2.0 + JWT security flaws **Aug 22**
- [] NIST AI Risk Management Framework + EU AI Act awareness **Aug 22**
- [] Write sample AI Usage Policy for an organization **Aug 23**
- [] AZ-900 study: Microsoft Learn path (~8 hrs free). Optionally sit exam (\$125). **Aug 24**
- [] Azure labs: deploy basic App Service + understand Entra ID, Defender, Sentinel basics **Aug 24**
- [] Add AI security section to ParcelVision: threat model for Gemini API integration **Aug 24**

DEADLINE: August 24 — AI security knowledge complete. 7 write-ups published. Azure exposure done. OWASP/GRC interview-ready.

AI SECURITY RESOURCES

- **OWASP Top 10 for LLM Applications:** owasp.org — THE reference. Read cover to cover.
- **MITRE ATLAS:** atlas.mitre.org — Study like ATT&CK.
- **Embrace The Red (Johann Rehberger):** Leading indirect prompt injection researcher.
- **Joseph Thacker / rez0 (YouTube):** AI/LLM bug bounty. Real exploits.
- **DEF CON AI Village talks:** YouTube. Cutting-edge AI security research.
- **Trail of Bits AI Security Blog:** Deep technical ML/AI vulnerability analysis.
- **PortSwigger Web Security Academy:** portswigger.net/web-security — Best AppSec training.

- **Rana Khalil (YouTube):** PortSwigger walkthroughs. Logic, not just steps.
- **PwnFunction (YouTube):** Animated web vuln explanations.

PHASE 6 — JOB SEARCH LAUNCH

August 25 – September 1, 2026 | 1 Week Launch (then ongoing)

Goal: By Sep 1 you have 3 certs (CCP + SAA + Security+), a live cloud project, 7 security write-ups, AI security knowledge, and Azure exposure. This week you package it all and start applying. 15+ targeted apps/week from Sep 1 onward.

Launch Week (Aug 25 – Sep 1)

- [] Create master resume with all projects, 3 certs, and skills **Aug 26**
- [] 3 tailored variants: Cloud/DevOps, GRC/Security, SOC/SecOps **Aug 27**
- [] LinkedIn headline: 'AWS SAA | Security+ | Cloud Security | DevOps | AI Security' **Aug 27**
- [] Portfolio page/README: ParcelVision + security write-ups + AI security labs **Aug 28**
- [] 'Tell me about yourself' pitch for each role type (practice out loud 5x each) **Aug 29**
- [] Set LinkedIn job alerts for all target role titles + Toronto **Aug 29**
- [] Submit first 15 targeted applications **Sep 1**

DEADLINE: September 1 — Job search LIVE. Everything done. All preparation complete.

Application Targets:

Type	Companies	Roles
Banks	RBC, TD, BMO, Scotiabank, CIBC	IT Risk Analyst, GRC Analyst, Cloud Engineer, Technology Risk, Info Security Analyst
Consulting	Deloitte, EY, KPMG, PwC, CGI, Accenture	Jr Security Consultant, Cloud Consultant, Risk Advisory, Tech Consulting
MSSPs	Arctic Wolf, eSentire, GoSecure, Cyderes, CrowdStrike	SOC Analyst, Security Analyst, Threat Analyst, Detection Engineer
Tech	AWS, Shopify, Wealthsimple, 1Password	Cloud Support, DevOps, SRE, Platform Engineer, Infra Engineer
Gov	CSE/CCCS, Shared Services, Ontario PS	IT Security Analyst, Cloud Ops, Systems Admin

Job Boards:

- **LinkedIn Jobs:** Primary. Alerts for all role titles + Toronto.
- **Indeed Canada + Company career pages:** Banks/Big 4 post on own portals first.
- **GCJobs (jobs.gc.ca):** Government. Slow but stable.
- **YorkU Career Hub:** University connections matter.

Networking (start during Phase 4, continue post Sep 1):

- [] BSides Toronto / SecTor — attend when scheduled
- [] OWASP Toronto Chapter — monthly meetups
- [] Toronto AWS User Group — monthly meetups
- [] ISACA Toronto Chapter — GRC focused, bank connections

POST SEP 1 — OFFENSIVE SECURITY (background, while job searching):

OffSec is Tier 3. Do NOT spend time on this before Sep 1. Once job search is active, spend 1–2 hrs/day on CTFs as skill building. Target OSCP only after you're employed.

- [] HackTheBox Starting Point + 10 Easy machines
- [] TryHackMe Jr Penetration Tester path
- [] Blog write-ups for every machine (methodology, not just flags)
- [] Evaluate OSCP purchase once employed
- **IppSec (YouTube):** Gold standard HTB walkthroughs.

- **TCM Security (Heath Adams):** Best affordable pentesting course (\$30/mo).
- **Conda / Alh4zr3d / John Hammond (YouTube):** Practical offsec content.

CERTIFICATION SEQUENCE

#	Certification	Deadline	Cost (CAD)	Why
1	AWS Cloud Practitioner	May 11	~\$140	Cloud vocabulary foundation. Gateway to SAA.
2	AWS Solutions Architect Assoc	Jun 15	~\$260	Primary cloud credential. 3,000+ Toronto jobs. Global portability.
3	CompTIA Security+ SY0-701	Jul 12	~\$500	Universal security entry ticket. Banks/SOC/GRC all filter on it.
4	AZ-900 (optional)	Aug 24	~\$125	Multi-cloud signal. Easy win if time allows.
5	AWS Security Specialty	Post-hire	~\$200	Cloud security differentiator. Study once employed.
6	OSCP	2027-28	~\$2,200 USD	OffSec gold standard. Only after 12+ months employed.

COST BREAKDOWN

Item	CAD	Required?
AWS CCP Exam	~\$140	Yes
Cantrill SAA Course	~\$60	Yes
AWS SAA Exam	~\$200	Yes
Tutorials Dojo (CCP + SAA)	~\$25	Yes
Security+ Exam	~\$500	Yes
Messer Practice Exams	~\$40	Yes
AZ-900 Exam	~\$125	Recommended
AWS Free Tier overages	~\$30	Budget for it
TOTAL (Essential)	~\$995	
TOTAL (Everything)	~\$1,120	

NON-NEGOTIABLE RULES

- 30+ hours/week. This compressed timeline does NOT work at 15 hrs/week. Be honest with yourself.
- One cert at a time. CCP → SAA → Security+. Never parallel cert study.
- Do NOT skip labs. A cert without hands-on is a piece of paper. The labs are the learning.
- Phase 4 is the hardest phase — project + 3 concurrent skill tracks. Plan your days hour by hour.
- Offensive security is POST Sep 1 only. Do not touch CTFs before your certs and project are done.
- AI security is your EDGE. Most 2027 grads won't know OWASP LLM Top 10. You will. Lean into it.
- AWS first, Azure second. AZ-900 is a nice-to-have. SAA is the must-have.
- Your ParcelVision project + write-ups matter more than a 4th certification.
- Apply broadly from Sep 1: banks, MSSPs, consulting. Get employed. Specialize later.
- If you fall behind, cut AZ-900 and OffSec first. Never cut certs or the project.

MASTER MILESTONE CHECKLIST

- [] **[May 11]** AWS Cloud Practitioner (CLF-C02) — PASSED
- [] **[Jun 15]** AWS Solutions Architect Associate (SAA-C03) — PASSED
- [] **[Jul 12]** CompTIA Security+ SY0-701 — PASSED
- [] **[Aug 3]** ParcelVision Cloud Redeployment — LIVE on AWS with full documentation
- [] **[Aug 3]** PortSwigger Academy — Core lab categories complete (SQLi, XSS, Auth, Access Control, SSRF)
- [] **[Aug 3]** Splunk Fundamentals 1 + BOTS v1 investigation — Complete
- [] **[Aug 3]** TryHackMe SOC Level 1 path — Complete
- [] **[Aug 3]** GRC frameworks (SOC 2, ISO 27001, NIST CSF, OSFI B-13, PIPEDA) — Interview ready
- [] **[Aug 3]** 3 AppSec vulnerability write-ups — Published
- [] **[Aug 17]** OWASP LLM Top 10 + MITRE ATLAS — Can explain in interview
- [] **[Aug 17]** Vulnerable LLM app exploited + guardrails implemented (labs complete)
- [] **[Aug 24]** 2 AI security blog posts — Published (total = 5 AppSec + 2 AI = 7 write-ups)
- [] **[Aug 24]** Remaining 2 AppSec write-ups complete (total = 5)
- [] **[Aug 24]** OWASP Top 10 (2021) + OAuth/JWT security — Can explain in interview
- [] **[Aug 24]** NIST AI RMF + EU AI Act — Awareness level for GRC interviews
- [] **[Aug 24]** AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals — Studied (exam optional)
- [] **[Aug 24]** AI security section added to ParcelVision (Gemini API threat model)
- [] **[Aug 28]** 3 resume variants + LinkedIn + portfolio page — Complete
- [] **[Sep 1]** First 15 targeted job applications — Submitted
- [] **[Sep 1]** ALL PREPARATION COMPLETE. Job search is now full-time alongside school/work.
- [] **[Q1 2027]** EMPLOYED in a Tier 1 or Tier 2 role

4 months. 3 certs. 1 production project. 7 security write-ups. AI-era security knowledge. Multi-cloud exposure.

This is a sprint, not a marathon. The pace is brutal but the payoff is real: by September 1 you'll have more demonstrable skills than 90% of 2027 CS grads applying for the same roles.

The goal hasn't changed: get inside the ecosystem. Get hired. Then specialize from the inside. Every day you delay starting is a day closer to graduation without preparation.

Start May 1. No excuses.